

shown as options. Psychologically, you press and therefore apply pressure to activate the resistive screen. In this case, using a capacitive screen would be unnecessary as you don't really need multi-touch gestures or high-end screens.

How challenging was porting Android for an automotive system?

A challenge there is to boot-up Android very fast as the device has to become available as soon as the ignition is turned on. As these devices don't have the option to go on standby, they turn off completely when the car's ignition is off. So the devices are required to boot up within a few seconds.

We set up a working version of Android, took a snapshot and booted up from that snapshot. That method did work and Android did come up, but all the other devices are switched off at that point. The devices have to independently come up and then synchronise so that these (file system, GPU, etc) are in the same state.

Did you come across any bug as you ported Android for the automotive market?

When unmounting the file system as it shuts down,

We used a pixel pipeline on the processor and some optimised video codecs to improve the performance

one particular file system was not unmounting because some application was using it. The problem was that the file system was not being used directly but through memory map. So looking at the list of open file systems and tables showed all of them to be closed.

Please tell us more about your activities.

AllGo Embedded Systems is a seven-year-old company in embedded market media space. We do complete product design including hardware and software, and outsource manufacturing in embedded market media and digital signal processing (DSP) space. Our expertise is in hardware and software co-design.

We are entirely an engineering house. Around 90 per cent of us can code. That makes up around 70 design engineers.

What's next from AllGo?

The next requirement would be a larger and faster device capable of handling better graphics and animation. We have two models of Stamp 2—a 17.8cm (7-inch) version and a 125.4cm (10-inch) version with capacitive touchscreen. ●



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